

National Taiwan University
Department of Economics
ECON 1020: Principles of Microeconomics (with recitation)
Fall 2026

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Teaching Assistants:

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Class Time and Location

Lecture classes:

Fridays at 10:20 AM – 1:10 PM
Room 103, Liberal Arts Teaching Hall

Recitations (TA Sessions):

Section 1 (All weeks; led by **Wan-Ting Chang**, Lead TA):
Mondays and Wednesdays at 12:20 PM – 1:10 PM
Room 103, Liberal Arts Teaching Hall
Section 2 (From Week 2; led by **Chi-Ying Chen**):
Mondays and Wednesdays at 12:20 PM – 1:10 PM
Room 406, College of Social Sciences

Students are free to attend either recitation section. However, all quizzes will be held in Room 103, Liberal Arts Teaching Hall.

Course Description

This course introduces the fundamental principles of microeconomics, covering the economic behavior of individual consumers, firms, and markets. Topics include supply and demand, elasticity, utility, production, cost, market structures (perfect competition, monopoly, monopolistic competition, and oligopoly), factor markets, and market failure, with an emphasis on applying these concepts to real-world situations. No prior background in economics is required.

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Explain and apply the ten principles of economics;
- Analyze how supply, demand, and elasticity determine market outcomes and respond to government policies;

- Evaluate the efficiency and welfare implications of taxation, trade, and market interventions;
- Distinguish between externalities, public goods, and common resources, and explain why markets fail to allocate them efficiently;
- Analyze the cost structure of firms and their production decisions;
- Compare firm and market outcomes under perfect competition, monopoly, monopolistic competition, and oligopoly;
- Apply microeconomic reasoning to current economic issues and policy debates.

Course Requirements

Students are required to attend classes regularly, complete homework assignments, take quizzes, take the midterm exam, take the final exam, and submit the required essays. Attendance is expected but not tracked or directly graded (unless through quizzes/exams). Students may discuss homework and essays with classmates or use generative AI tools while working on them. However, students must use classmates' or AI assistance critically: they must understand, be able to defend, and take full responsibility for everything they write (for example, "AI wrote it" is not a valid excuse for errors or plagiarism). Quizzes and exams are closed-book, meaning that AI and other outside assistance are not permitted.

The three essays are "economics in the news" assignments: for each one, students find a recent news article and analyze it using the economic concepts covered in class up to that point. Each essay should be 500–700 words (roughly two pages, double-spaced, 12pt font), and must (1) briefly summarize the article and cite its source, (2) identify the specific economic concept(s) from the course that apply, (3) analyze the situation using those concepts, with a diagram where appropriate, and (4) if the article raises a policy question, distinguish clearly between positive analysis (what would happen) and normative judgment (what should be done).

Generative AI in Course Material Preparation

I use Claude Code (Anthropic's Claude Sonnet 5 model) to assist me in preparing lecture slides, homework, quizzes, and exams, drawing on the PowerPoint slides and test bank that the textbook publisher provides. I direct this process closely, specifying the content, structure, and approach for each item. I review, revise, and finalize all such material myself, and I take full responsibility for any errors it contains.

Textbook

Mankiw, N. Gregory. *Principles of Economics*, 11th ed., Asia Edition, Cengage, 2027.

Here is the publisher's link to purchase the book at discount: <https://pse.is/9jy8ue>. Using the 10th or 9th edition for required readings is also fine.

Grading

Weekly Homework (graded based on completion; all except highest 3 dropped): 10%

Quizzes (4 total; lowest score dropped): 15%

Short Essays (3 total): 15%

Midterm Exam (Friday, October 30): 30%

Final Exam (Friday, December 18): 30%

Final letter grades are assigned from the total course percentage according to NTU's official numeric grading scale. I may apply an upward curve.

A+	90–100	B+	77–79	C+	67–69
A	85–89	B	73–76	C	63–66
A-	80–84	B-	70–72	C-	60–62

A score of 60 (C-) is the minimum passing grade for the course. Scores from 50–59 (D) and below 50 (E) do not receive a passing grade.

Academic Integrity

Cheating on quizzes and exams is strictly prohibited. Cheating includes, but is not limited to:

- Bringing unauthorized notes, study aids, or texts into the room, or consulting them outside the room during the quiz or exam (e.g., in the bathroom);
- Using a cell phone or other electronic device to store or access information during the quiz or exam;
- Having another person take the quiz or exam on your behalf;
- Communicating with classmates, looking at their work, or allowing others to look at your work during the quiz or exam.

In addition, students must avoid plagiarism in their essays. Plagiarism means presenting another person's work or ideas as your own without attribution; it does not include ideas generated from interacting with generative AI. Plagiarism includes, but is not limited to:

- representing another person's work or ideas as one's own;
- unacknowledged word-for-word use and/or paraphrasing of another person's work;
- inappropriate unacknowledged use of another person's ideas;
- submitting one's previous work (e.g. from a different class).

Absence Policy

Students who miss a quiz, essay deadline, or exam due to illness, injury, a family emergency, or other serious circumstances beyond their control must report the situation through myNTU as soon as possible, and in any case within three days of the missed date. Only absences reported this way will be considered for accommodation.

- **Quizzes:** Since the lowest of the four quiz scores is already dropped, a single missed quiz needs no further accommodation. A second excused absence will also be dropped; additional missed quizzes are scored as zero.
- **Essays:** An excused absence extends that essay's deadline by the length of the emergency, up to one week, unless other arrangements are made with the instructor in advance.
- **Midterm Exam:** A student with an excused absence from the midterm will have their final exam score substituted for the midterm grade (the final then counts for 60% of the course grade). There is no separate makeup midterm.
- **Final Exam:** There is no makeup for the final exam except in extraordinary circumstances approved by the instructor in advance.

Course Schedule

The following is a tentative course schedule. Specific dates and topics are subject to adjustment.

Week	Date	Topic and required reading
Week 1	09/07	TA Session
	09/09	TA Session
	09/11	Lecture • Ten Principles of Economics (Ch.1) • Thinking Like an Economist (Ch.2)
Week 2	09/14	TA Session – Homework 1 Due
	09/16	TA Session
	09/18	Lecture • Interdependence and the Gains from Trade (Ch.3) • The Market Forces of Supply and Demand (Ch.4)
Week 3	09/21	TA Session – Homework 2 Due
	09/23	Quiz 1 (Room 103, Liberal Arts Teaching Hall)
	09/25	Moon Festival – No class
Week 4	09/28	Teacher’s Day – No class
	09/30	TA Session
	10/02	Lecture • Elasticity and Its Application (Ch.5) • Supply, Demand, and Government Policies (Ch.6)
Week 5	10/05	TA Session – Homework 3 Due
	10/07	TA Session
	10/09	National Day (make-up holiday) – No class
Week 6	10/12	TA Session
	10/14	TA Session – First Essay Due
	10/16	Lecture • Consumers, Producers, and the Efficiency of Markets (Ch.7) • The Costs of Taxation (Ch.8)
Week 7	10/19	TA Session – Homework 4 Due
	10/21	Quiz 2 (Room 103, Liberal Arts Teaching Hall)
	10/23	Lecture • International Trade (Ch.9) • Externalities (Ch.10)
Week 8	10/26	Retrocession Day – No class
	10/28	TA Session – Homework 5 Due
	10/30	Midterm Exam
Week 9	11/02	TA Session
	11/04	TA Session

Week	Date	Topic and required reading
	11/06	Lecture • Public Goods and Common Resources (Ch.11) • The Cost of Production (Ch.14)
Week 10	11/09 11/11 11/13	TA Session – Homework 6 Due TA Session Lecture • Firms in Competitive Markets (Ch.15) • Monopoly (Ch.16)
Week 11	11/16 11/18 11/20	TA Session – Homework 7 Due Quiz 3 (Room 103, Liberal Arts Teaching Hall) University Games – No class
Week 12	11/23 11/25 11/27	TA Session TA Session – Second Essay Due Lecture • Monopolistic Competition (Ch.17) • Oligopoly (Ch.18)
Week 13	11/30 12/02 12/04	TA Session – Homework 8 Due Quiz 4 (Room 103, Liberal Arts Teaching Hall) Instructor Travel – No class
Week 14	12/07 12/09 12/11	TA Session TA Session Lecture • Frontiers of Microeconomics (Ch.23)
Week 15	12/14 12/16 12/18	TA Session – Homework 9 Due TA Session Final Exam
Week 16	12/21 12/23 12/25	TA Session TA Session – Final Essay Due Constitution Day – No class